

Step 1: Area of Interest (AOI)

Draw the place you care about — everything downstream is scoped to this shape.

Your AOI (Area of Interest) is the polygon or rectangle that defines the region the whole toolkit searches, filters, and downloads imagery for. You draw it once and it's reused by every later step.

How to draw one

- 1 Use the rectangle or polygon tool on the map (top-left drawing toolbar).
- 2 Draw exactly **one** shape over your area. If you draw more than one, only the last shape is used.
- 3 Click **Save as AOI** (dashboard) or run the export cell (notebook).

Sizing your AOI

- Keep it reasonably small (a farm field, a watershed, a small county) — the search step queries every scene that even partially overlaps your AOI, so a very large AOI (a whole state or country) means far more results and much slower searches.
- Very small AOIs (a few hundred meters across) are fine and often ideal for field-scale work.

What gets created

Saving writes three files with the same shape, for different uses:

File	Use
.geojson	Read by every other step in this toolkit
.kml	Open in Google Earth
.kmz	Compressed KML, smaller file size

■■ **Watch out** — If you redraw and re-save with the same AOI name, it silently overwrites the previous files. Use a different AOI_NAME if you want to keep more than one area side by side.